SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #3 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"I must hold on to everything."

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Where it often comes from

When money, food, or comfort were scarce, holding on tightly was how a family survived. Saving everything, never wasting, and never letting go can feel like the only safe way. A person may also have been shamed for spending or giving, or may have lived through a loss that taught them to guard what is left.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors saving, planning, and care for what we own. It also warns that life does not consist in the abundance of possessions, and that gripping what we have can crowd out trust. God tells us to be generous and to put our hope in Him, not in uncertain wealth. Giving does not mean being careless; it means holding things with an open hand, trusting that God is our source and that generosity is part of how He refreshes us.

> *"And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"* (Luke 12:15).

Also see

> "Do not be afraid, little flock, for your Father is pleased to give you the kingdom" (Luke 12:32).

> "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life" (1 Timothy 6:17–19).

> "One gives freely, yet gains even more; another withholds what is right, only to become poor. A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed" (Proverbs 11:24–25).

> "In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.'" (Acts 20:35).

Common self-statements

- If I let go of anything, I will regret it.
- I might need it someday.
- Throwing things out is wasteful and dangerous.
- I cannot give; I need everything I have.
- Letting go means losing.
- If I hold on tight enough, I will stay safe.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will need exactly what I let go.
- Catastrophizing: Treating letting go of a small thing as a threat to survival.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I must keep everything or risk losing everything.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling anxious when I let go and concluding that it is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What am I afraid will happen if I let something go?
- How often have I actually needed an item I kept "just in case"?
- What has holding on cost me in space, peace, or relationships?
- What did I learn early in life about keeping and losing?
- Where does Scripture connect trust with open hands?
- What is one small thing I could release or share this week?
- What would I tell a friend who felt this way?

Truth summary

> Saving and caring for what I have is wise. But I do not have to hold on to everything to be safe. My security comes from God, not from what I keep. I can hold things with an open hand, share when I am able, and let go of what I do not need.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Greedy/Stingy
- Giving
- Riches, Beware of
- Money
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Even If — MercyMe
Trust in God need not depend on receiving the particular miracle we want.

Greater — MercyMe
God's presence and grace challenge shame and the need to win everyone's approval.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must hold on to everything"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must hold on to everything." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I fear will happen if I let go?
- ☐ How often have I needed what I kept?
- ☐ What has holding on cost me?
- ☐ What did I learn early about keeping and losing?
- ☐ What small thing could I release?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My safety comes from God, not from what I keep.
- ☐ I can save wisely and still let go.
- ☐ Giving can bring peace, not only loss.
- ☐ I do not need to keep everything "just in case."
- ☐ Letting go of small things is a safe practice.
- ☐ An open hand is not a careless hand.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Luke 12:15**
  "And He said to them, 'Watch out! Guard yourselves against every form of greed, for one's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions.'"
- ☐ **1 Timothy 6:17–19**
  "Instruct those who are rich in the present age not to be conceited and not to put their hope in the uncertainty of wealth, but in God, who richly provides all things for us to enjoy. Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share, treasuring up for themselves a firm foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of that which is truly life."
- ☐ **Proverbs 11:24–25**
  "One gives freely, yet gains even more; another withholds what is right, only to become poor. A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I kept and what I released: Record one thing you let go of or shared, your fear before from 0 to 10, and what actually happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Luke 12:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My life is more than what I keep, and God is my source.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Giving" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Release one small, low-risk item. Choose something you have not used in a year. Predict how upsetting it will be from 0 to 10, let it go, and record what happened.
- [ ] Share something small. Give a small amount of time, food, or money. Notice the fear and what you feel afterward.
- [ ] Set a "keep" rule. Decide in advance what is worth keeping, such as important papers or sentimental items, so the rest is easier to release.
- [ ] Pray with open hands. Hold your hands open for one minute and thank God that He is your source.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must hold on to everything": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One thing released
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must hold on to everything.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know why I hold so tightly. Teach me to trust You as my provider. Help me keep what is wise, release what I do not need, and give with an open hand. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.